Stefan Herytash

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15 October 2026

Thyra Uth Thomsen, Head of Department, and the assessment committee
Department of Marketing
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Application for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing

Dear Thyra Uth Thomsen and members of the assessment committee,

I am an Assistant Professor at WU Vienna and apply for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing. I trained in mathematics at TU Wien and the University of Zurich, and took my PhD in Management, summa cum laude, at the Institute for Market-Based Management of LMU Munich, with a thesis on simulating human decision-making with large language models. I work in quantitative marketing, and digital marketing is where I apply it: in pre-tests, in pricing and promotion, and on platforms.

A firm can now pre-test an ad, a landing page, an offer or a price on answers that a language model writes in seconds, where it once paid a consumer panel. My solo paper *When and How to Integrate AI Simulations into Behavioral Experimentation* (Revise & Resubmit at the **International Journal of Research in Marketing**) measures how far such answers can be trusted. I simulate 70 treatment effects from 30 published marketing studies at the level of the instrument: each synthetic respondent completes the original questionnaire in one randomized condition. Simulated and human effects correlate at $r = .73$, but the simulated effects come out at about two-fifths of the human magnitudes. They can rank ideas before a test is run; they cannot yet price them. At CBS this benchmark would sit next to Felix Eggers' work on language-model valuations and design priors for choice experiments.

Pricing and promotion are the econometric side of my measurement work. In a many-analyst study forthcoming in the **International Journal of Research in Marketing**, I was one of 156 analyst teams that estimated brand price elasticities from the same household panel data. The team averages range from −7.3 to +3.1, and choices on time aggregation, fixed effects, time controls and marketing-mix covariates explain the largest share of that spread. Promotion planning rests on these elasticities, which ties the work to the Digital Marketing Research Cluster's projects on online promotions and customer value. In Denmark I would like to approach Salling Group, the country's largest retailer, to estimate how its customers respond to prices and promotions and to pre-test offers digitally before they reach the stores. At LMU I also worked on predicting engagement with social media ads using machine learning.

Digital platforms certify sellers and wages through thresholds: a badge above a rating, a salary band above a number of reports. kununu, the largest employer-review and salary platform in the German-speaking labour market, shows a salary band only once enough employees have reported one. Since August I have been negotiating a multi-year data partnership with kununu, and the paper I am preparing estimates what that threshold does to applicant flows. Airbnb, whose data I worked on at LMU, certifies hosts the same way: its Superhost badge requires an average rating of at least 4.8 and thresholds on response, cancellations and stays. In a project I plan, a regression discontinuity at these thresholds in the public Inside Airbnb snapshots would separate the badge from the quality it is meant to signal. Trustpilot, the review platform founded in Denmark and based in Copenhagen, rates businesses from their customers' reviews, and I would like to study its ratings as a certification of the same kind. My paper *The Matching Cost of Pay Transparency* asks whether transparency changes whom firms hire; through CBS I could test it on Statistics Denmark's linked employer-employee registers, next to the Revelio data it uses now. The same question about certification runs through *After the Fax Machine Burns* (Submitted to

Management Science as a Discussion Paper), on what a journal should certify when manuscripts cost almost nothing to write, and *Threshold Migration to the Patient* (Accepted at **ANZAM 2026**), which follows a consumer wearable into a profession's gate.

The department ranks among Europe's top five business schools for publications in leading marketing journals, and the Digital Marketing Research Cluster is where my work belongs. CogLab and the experiments.cbs.dk participant pool would let me run the simulated and the human version of the same study side by side on Danish samples; so far my benchmark compares simulations with published results. With Carlsberg, a partner of the department's Consumer Research Cluster, I would like to compare simulated and human pre-tests of brand and pricing decisions. CBS's strategic initiative Accelerating AI and Digitalisation fits the simulation work, and the department's Responsible Marketing & Societal impact fits the certification work: a badge or a salary band is a public claim about quality that consumers and workers rely on.

At WU I designed *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, in which students build and evaluate working agents; 95 % of the students recommend it. This term I run the *Business Project* of WU's master's programme with Vienna Airport as corporate partner. At LMU Munich I taught the *Seminar on AI in Marketing* in 2024 and 2025 and the exercise sessions of *Marketing Management*, and at EM Lyon the course *Analyzing Markets*. At CBS I would offer a master's elective on generative AI as a marketing research method, in which students test simulated respondents against human data and build agentic analysis workflows. It would sit one level above the applied AI courses in the bachelor's programmes and the GMA summer school, and next to Brand Analytics in the EMF.

I will relocate to Copenhagen and be present in the department. I will learn Danish, which I am eager to do. Besides the master's elective, I will teach general marketing at bachelor's level again, as I did at LMU and EM Lyon. I would also like to teach executives: at WU I teach the AI sessions of the *Vienna Innovation Program*, an executive-level programme for North American Master of Business Administration students. I will explain what my research means for society, both to the public and to CBS's partners in business, in talks for practitioners and through the interactive figures of my papers on my website. I will publish the data and code of each paper when it is published.

At WU I serve on the appointment committee for the Full Professor of Strategic Management and review for the Schmalenbach Journal of Business Research and four conferences. At CBS I will contribute from the first semester in research, in teaching and in the department, including CBS-wide tasks. At LMU I raised over €100,000 in research funding for the institute from industry partners, and as a freelance consultant I ran market research and analytics for clients including Bayer and Allianz. In Denmark I would apply first to the Independent Research Fund Denmark's thematic call Research on Artificial Intelligence, with a senior colleague from the department.

I can start on 1 September 2027. From January to March 2027 I am a Visiting Scholar at the Scandinavian Consortium for Organizational Research at Stanford. The application documents are also at `https://sherytash.github.io/for/cbs/`.

Sincerely,

Stefan Herytash